

# FAST 4+1 B.A./M.A.: where to start

Falcon Accelerated Success Track · for prospective and current B.A. in Music students



FAST 4+1 page

| Degrees                         | Length                                                | Shared units                              | Contact                             |
|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| B.A. in Music and M.A. in Music | Five years from first-year entry, three from transfer | Up to 12 graduate units count toward both | Inés Thiebaut, Graduate Coordinator |

## 01 The program

FAST leads to both the Bachelor of Arts and the Master of Arts in Music. You enter as a B.A. student and apply to FAST from within the B.A. You take your first two semesters of graduate study alongside your last undergraduate year, and up to 12 units of M.A. coursework taken in residence at East Bay count toward both degrees. The program ends with at least one semester of 8 or more units of graduate courses only, after the B.A. is awarded.

You declare one M.A. emphasis: Performance (Classical or Jazz), Choral Conducting, or Composition. The M.A. is a graduate seminar core with applied study and ensemble every semester, and it ends with a public capstone and a comprehensive examination.



FAST roadmaps

## 02 Paths through FAST

First-year students take the B.A. for three years, apply to FAST in the junior year, and finish both degrees in five years. Transfer students with the Associate Degree for Transfer in Music enter at junior standing, apply in their second semester in residence, and finish both degrees in three years.

## 03 Eligibility

- Current enrollment in the B.A. in Music at CSU East Bay as a first bachelor's degree. Second-bachelor's students aren't eligible.
- Music as the only major. Double majors aren't eligible.
- 60 to 90 program-applicable units completed, including the 15 units of lower-division core music coursework and the lower-division general education requirements. Program-applicable units are the units that count toward the major, general education, and university requirements.
- A cumulative GPA of at least 3.0.

International students on an F-1 visa contact the Center for International Education before applying.

## 04 Getting started at East Bay

FAST begins with admission to the B.A. in Music. Apply to CSU East Bay through Cal State Apply, choosing the B.A. in Music, and sign up for an applied area placement to begin lessons.



B.A. in Music page

## 05 How to apply

1. Write to the Graduate Coordinator for the FAST application form. Apply in the Fall or the Spring semester, by the end of week 7. If you apply in the Fall, you begin FAST coursework in the Spring, and if you apply in the Spring, you begin in the Fall.
2. Prepare the M.A. in Music materials:
  - a CV or résumé
  - two letters of recommendation from teachers or colleagues who can speak to your readiness for graduate study, emailed by your recommenders to the Graduate Coordinator
  - a 2-page statement of purpose on what you want from a graduate degree in music and your short- and long-term goals
  - evidence of your work in your area of emphasis, as set out for the M.A. on the Department's How to Apply page
3. Email your application to the Graduate Coordinator as the FAST application form sets out.
4. On admission, you and the Graduate Coordinator approve the university FAST form, and the Office of the Registrar moves you onto the FAST plan.



FAST in the  
undergraduate  
handbook



How to Apply, M.A.  
materials

## 06 Once you're in FAST

You meet with the Graduate Coordinator every semester. In undergraduate status, you keep a cumulative GPA of at least 3.0 and a GPA of at least 3.0 in upper-division and graduate courses. You move to graduate status in the semester after completing 120 program-applicable units, graduate units included, with every university-wide undergraduate requirement complete. The Office of the Registrar makes the change, and there's no second application.

You pay undergraduate tuition until the move to graduate status and graduate tuition from then on. In graduate status, you're eligible for Graduate Equity Fellowships through the Office of Graduate Studies. FAST students don't pursue a minor unless it's approved by exception. Your transcript shows the B.A. and the M.A.

## 07 Certificate in Music Education

You can take the Certificate in Music Education alongside FAST. The certificate covers the subject matter coursework for the California Single Subject Teaching Credential in Music. The credential itself is a separate program. John Eros coordinates music education ([john.eros@csueastbay.edu](mailto:john.eros@csueastbay.edu)).



Music education

## 08 Contacts

| Office                     | Contact                                                                                                                   |
|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Graduate Coordinator       | Inés Thiebaut · MB 2012 · (510) 885-3126 · <a href="mailto:ines.thiebaut@csueastbay.edu">ines.thiebaut@csueastbay.edu</a> |
| Music office               | MB 2569 · (510) 885-3135 · <a href="mailto:music@csueastbay.edu">music@csueastbay.edu</a>                                 |
| Office of Graduate Studies | (510) 885-3716 · <a href="mailto:gradstudies@csueastbay.edu">gradstudies@csueastbay.edu</a>                               |

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